

What is a node pool?

- Nodes with the same configuration are grouped together into node pools in AKS. These node pools contain the supporting virtual machines that run your containerized applications
- In AKS, you should not create VMSS or VMAS, but node pools
 - A node pool creation will result in the provisioning of a VMSS (Scale Set) or VMAS (Availability Set)
 - Each VMSS or VMAS will include VM instances customized to run as AKS nodes
- When you create an AKS cluster, a node pool is automatically created
- You can have multiple node pools that are separate and isolate deployments of VMs within the cluster. This provides you flexibility to manage and set up multiple environments within the same cluster, to have dedicated and isolated compute resources for different applications, and so on
- Two types of node pool: System and User. At least one System node pool needs to exist

